

A mid-career demon in hell's Hauntings department gets what looks like the assignment of his career: a house with old bones, good acoustics, and a widower living alone.

The demon is good at his job. He maps the joist intervals. He stands in a doorway for thirty-seven minutes because the protocol says three seconds and Gordon won't wake up.

Then the demon notices who he is haunting. A retired English teacher reading his dead wife's last book aloud to an empty room, one evening a week, picking up where her bookmark was.

The demon finishes the job anyway. The craft is the point.

Demons at Work



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